

USER MANUAL

RMS — Roster MS

Employee Roster Management System

Single-company, multi-role shift roster management

Built with Next.js · MongoDB · shadcn/ui

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University demo project — all data is fictional

Contents

1. Introduction
2. Getting Started (Login & Logout)
3. Roles & Permissions Overview
4. Guide for Employees
5. Guide for Team Leaders
6. Guide for Managers & Admins (Roster, Approvals, Requests, CSV)
7. Guide for Administrators (Teams, Users, Audit Log)
8. The Approval Workflow Explained
9. Shift Code Reference
10. FAQ & Troubleshooting

1. Introduction

RMS (Roster MS) is a web-based Employee Roster Management System for a single company. It lets managers build monthly shift rosters, lets employees view their schedules and request changes or swaps, and lets team leaders plan their own team's shifts — with every change to the roster reviewed and approved by a manager or administrator before it takes effect.

Key capabilities

- **Role-based access** — four roles (Admin, Manager, Team Leader, Employee), each with a tailored workspace.
- **Monthly roster calendar** — a grid of employees × days with color-coded shift codes.
- **Self-service requests** — employees request shift *changes* or *swaps* with teammates.
- **Leader proposals** — team leaders stage roster edits in a session and submit them as a batch for approval.
- **Bulk approvals** — managers/admins review proposed changes on a calendar and approve/reject many at once.
- **CSV import/export** — bulk-create or replace a month's roster from a spreadsheet.
- **Audit trail** — every roster edit, approval, and user-management action is recorded.

2. Getting Started

2.1 Opening the system

Open the deployed application URL in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox). You will be greeted by the **Sign in** screen. Without signing in you cannot view any page.

2.2 Signing in

1. Enter your **Username** — administrators and managers use their chosen username (e.g. `admin`); employees and team leaders sign in with their employee code in lowercase (e.g. `s11-10001`).
2. Enter your **Password**.
3. Click **Sign in**.

Demo accounts (password `demo123` for all): `admin` — Admin · `manager` — Manager · `s11-10001` — Team Leader · `s11-20001` — Employee.

2.3 Where you land

Role	Landing page after login
Admin / Manager / Team Leader	Dashboard (<code>/admin</code>) with workforce stats and pending-work shortcuts
Employee	My Schedule (<code>/my-schedule</code>)

2.4 Navigating

- **Desktop** — a sidebar on the left lists the pages available to your role.
- **Mobile** — tap the menu (☰) button at the top-left to open the navigation drawer.
- **Profile & logout** — the avatar button at the top-right opens your profile menu with a **Log out** action.

2.5 Signing out

Click the avatar (top-right) → **Log out**. You are returned to the Sign in screen and your session cookie is destroyed. Sessions expire automatically after 8 hours.

3. Roles & Permissions Overview

The table below summarises what each role can do. Anything not listed is blocked — both in the interface and, more importantly, enforced on the server.

Capability	Admin	Manager	Team Leader	Employee
Dashboard (stats & shortcuts)	✓	✓	✓	—
View own schedule & submit change/swap requests	—	—	✓	✓
View roster calendar	✓ (edit all)	✓ (edit all)	✓ (own team only)	✓ (read-only)
Edit roster directly (instant)	✓	✓	— (proposes instead)	—
Propose roster changes for approval	—	—	✓	—
Create a new roster month	✓	✓	✓	—
Approve / reject roster proposals (bulk)	✓	✓	—	—
Approve / reject employee change & swap requests	✓	✓	— (view only)	—
CSV import / export	✓	✓	—	—
Teams management	✓	—	—	—
Users management & password resets	✓	—	—	—
Audit log	✓	—	—	—

Why team leaders cannot approve: a leader planning shifts for their own team (and sometimes requesting changes for themselves) must not also hold approval power over those same changes. Approval authority is deliberately kept with Admin/Manager as a segregation of duties.

4. Guide for Employees

Employees land on **My Schedule**. This is the only workspace they need.

4.1 Reading your schedule

- **Today / Tomorrow cards** — your shift code for the next two days at a glance.
- **Monthly calendar** — every day of the month with your shift code; today is ring-highlighted, weekends have dashed borders. Hover a day to see the shift's exact times.
- **Upcoming work days** — your next working days (14-day look-ahead).
- **Time off this month** — your leave days (sick, casual, emergency, holiday).

4.2 Requesting a shift change

Use this when you want a *different shift on a date you are already scheduled*.

1. Click **Request Change** (or simply click the day in the calendar).
2. Pick the **Day** and the **New shift** code you want.
3. Write a short **Reason** (required).
4. Click **Submit**. A confirmation toast appears at the bottom-right.

4.3 Requesting a swap with a teammate

Use this when you want to *exchange shifts with someone on your team for the same day*.

1. Click **Request Swap**.
2. Pick the **Day** and the **teammate** you want to swap with (only your team's members are listed).
3. Write a **Reason** and click **Submit**.

4.4 Tracking your requests

The **My Requests** list at the bottom of the page shows your last 20 requests with their status: **PENDING** (awaiting a manager), **APPROVED** (roster already updated), or **REJECTED**. You may have only one pending request per date.

5. Guide for Team Leaders

A Team Leader is a working employee who also **plans the roster for their own team**. Their edits are proposals — they reach the roster only after an Admin or Manager approves them.

5.1 Your own schedule

Team leaders are scheduled in the roster just like employees. Open **My Schedule** (sidebar or profile menu) to view your shifts and to submit change/swap requests for yourself — exactly as described in section 4.

5.2 Viewing the team roster

Open **Roster** from the sidebar. You see the rows of **your team only**. Use the month selector to switch months. Cells with an **amber outline** already have a change awaiting approval.

5.3 Staging changes (the editing session)

1. Click any day cell and pick a shift code — the cell turns **solid amber** and the new code is shown immediately. Nothing is sent to the server yet.
2. Repeat for as many cells as you like — even across different months.
3. A “**Roster session**” panel appears in the **bottom-right corner** listing every staged change (employee, date, old → new). Remove an item with its × button if you change your mind.
4. When the batch looks right, click **Save changes**. All staged edits are submitted in one go and each becomes a pending proposal. **Discard** throws the session away without submitting.

Solid amber = staged in your session (not yet saved). Outlined amber = already submitted and awaiting approval. The two look different so you never lose track.

5.4 Creating a roster month

If the upcoming month has no roster yet, use the **New roster month** control at the top of the Roster page: pick any month (there is no date limit) and click the button. An empty roster is scaffolded for all active employees, ready to be filled in.

5.5 After you submit

Your proposals appear on the managers' **Approvals** page. Until they approve, the roster stays unchanged. You can watch the status via the amber outlines on your grid. Re-staging the same cell before it is reviewed simply updates your pending proposal.

6. Guide for Managers & Admins

Managers and Admins share the operational workspace; Admins additionally manage Teams, Users and the Audit log (section 7).

6.1 Dashboard

The dashboard shows live counts: active employees, teams, people working today, and pending items. If roster proposals are waiting, a banner links straight to the Approvals page.

6.2 Roster — direct editing

On the **Roster** page you see **all employees of all teams** and can **click any cell to set a shift instantly** — no approval needed. Every edit is written to the audit trail. Use the **New roster month** control to scaffold any future month, or the month selector to browse history.

6.3 Approvals — reviewing leader proposals (calendar)

1. Open **Approvals** from the sidebar. The **Pending** tab renders all proposed changes **on the actual roster calendar**: proposed cells are amber and show the proposed code.
2. Hover an amber cell to see the details — current code → proposed code, the shift times, and which team leader proposed it.
3. **Click amber cells to select** them (they get a ring). Use **Select all** / the header checkbox to grab everything for the month, or **Deselect all** to start over.
4. Click **Approve** to write every selected change onto the roster at once, or **Reject** to decline them. A toast confirms how many were applied.

Approving a cell automatically supersedes any other pending proposals for that same cell, so conflicts resolve themselves. The **Recent decisions** tab lists the last 30 decisions with who reviewed them.

6.4 Requests — employee change & swap requests

The **Requests** page lists employee requests, filterable by status tabs (All / Pending / Approved / Rejected). For a **CHANGE**, approving rewrites that employee's shift on that date. For a **SWAP**, approving exchanges the two employees' shifts for that date. Rejecting keeps the roster untouched. All decisions are audit-logged.

6.5 CSV import / export

- **Export** — download the current month's roster as a CSV (also includes a `team` column).
- **Template** — download a sample CSV showing the expected layout.
- **Import** — choose a month, attach a CSV, and click **Import & replace month**.

Warning: importing replaces the entire month's roster. The file must have `employeeCode` and `fullName` columns, an optional `team` column, then `Day1...Day31` columns of shift codes. Unknown codes create new employee accounts (default password `demo123`).

7. Guide for Administrators

7.1 Teams

- **Create / rename / delete** teams with the toolbar and card action buttons. Deleting a team un-assigns its members; it does not delete any account.
- **Set leader** (crown icon) — pick a member; an Employee is automatically promoted to TEAM_LEADER. Choose “— No leader —” to clear.
- **Add member** — pick any employee/leader; they are moved into this team. Remove someone with the minus button on their row.
- Use the search box to find a team, leader or member quickly.

7.2 Users

- **New User** — set full name, username, password, role, employee code (required for Employee/Team Leader, format `SLL-12345`) and team.
- **Edit** — change name, role, code, team, and the **Active** switch (a disabled user cannot sign in).
- **Reset password** (key icon) — set a new password for the user.
- Filter the table with the search box and role selector.

7.3 Audit log

A reverse-chronological record (latest 200 events) of every roster edit, proposal, approval, request decision, and user/team management action — who did what, to whom, and when. Action badges are color-coded by category: blue = roster, violet = requests, amber = users, cyan = teams.

8. The Approval Workflow Explained

Roster changes can enter the system two ways, and both end in a fully audited result:

- A) Admin / Manager edits a cell directly
 - └─ applied IMMEDIATELY + audit log entry

- B) Team Leader stages cells → “Save changes”
 - └─ PENDING proposals created
 - └─ Manager/Admin opens Approvals (calendar view)
 - └─ APPROVE (single or bulk) → roster updated + audit log
 - └─ REJECT (single or bulk) → nothing changes + audit log

- C) Employee (or Leader, for themselves) submits change/swap request
 - └─ Manager/Admin reviews on Requests page
 - └─ APPROVE → roster rewritten (change) or shifts exchanged (swap)
 - └─ REJECT → roster unchanged

Employees always see the approved, up-to-date roster on My Schedule. Rejected requests never touch the roster.

9. Shift Code Reference

Code	Meaning	Code	Meaning
M2	Morning shift 08:00–17:00	D0	Day Off
M3	Morning shift 09:00–18:00	SL	Sick Leave
M4	Morning shift 10:00–19:00	CL	Casual Leave
D1	Day shift 12:00–21:00	EL	Emergency Leave
D2	Day shift 13:00–22:00	HL	Holiday Leave

Work codes are M2 M3 M4 D1 D2 ; everything else is non-working time. An empty cell means no shift has been set for that day yet.

10. FAQ & Troubleshooting

I forgot my password.

Ask an Administrator to reset it (Users → key icon). Passwords are stored hashed and cannot be recovered.

My schedule shows “No roster published yet”.

No roster exists for this or next month. A manager, admin or team leader must create one (Roster → “New roster month”) or import a CSV.

Why is a cell amber on my roster grid?

Solid amber = you staged it in the current session and have not saved. **Outlined amber** = a proposal for that cell is pending approval. Once approved, the cell simply shows the new shift.

Why can't I click cells of other teams as a Team Leader?

Leaders manage their own team's rows only. Other teams are not part of your editing grid, and the server rejects any attempt to submit changes outside your team.

Why can't Team Leaders approve requests?

By design — see the note in section 3. Approval is reserved for Admin/Manager to avoid conflicts of interest.

I have two pending proposals for the same cell from different leaders. What happens?

Whichever the manager approves is applied; the other pending proposal for that cell is automatically marked rejected (superseded).

Can I request a swap with someone from another team?

No. Swaps are limited to teammates on your own team, enforced both in the interface and on the server.

Can I have more than one pending request for the same date?

No — one pending request per date. Wait for a decision or the request will be declined as a duplicate.

The toast notifications cover my view.

Notifications appear in the bottom-right corner and auto-dismiss; they are intentionally kept below the header controls.

Something looks wrong in the roster — who do I contact?

Your Manager or Administrator. Every change is traceable in the Audit log (Admins can see exactly who changed what and when).